

Gita Mananam

Living the Gita — Daily Inspiration and Contemplation

Volume — 2
(Chapters 7 — 12)

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Rishikesh, Uttarakhand, Bharat

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Edition - First, 2025

Typeset - Latex

Fonts - Helvetica, Sanskrit2020

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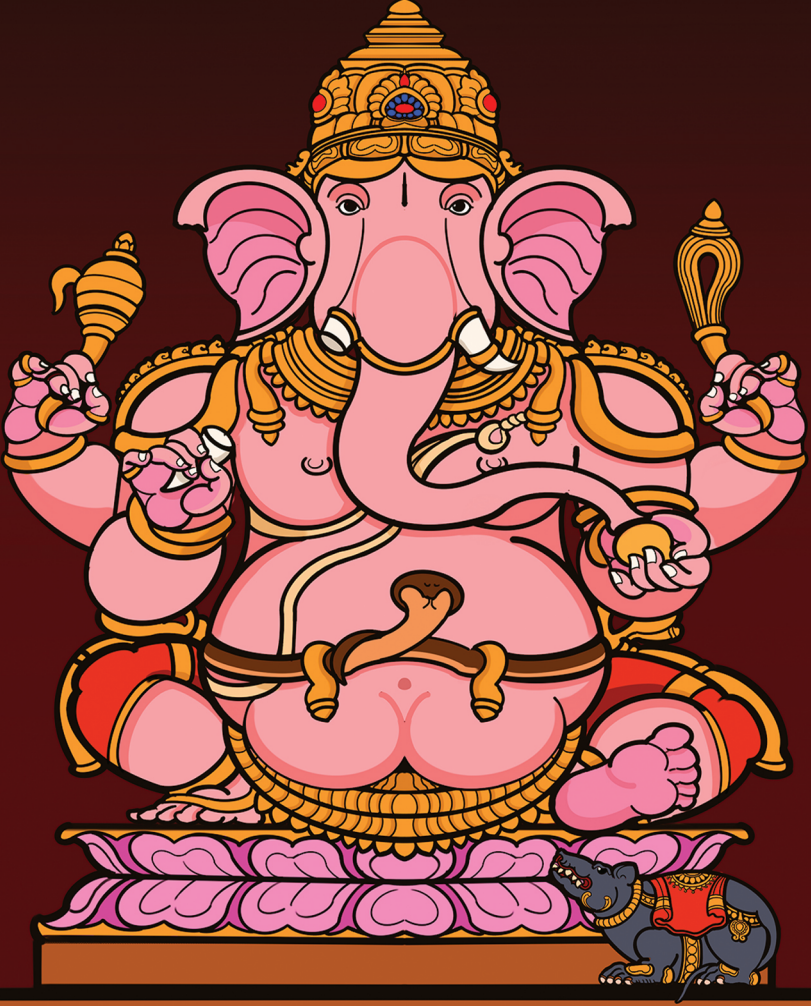
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Rishikesh, India

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गजाननं भूतगणादि सेवितं कपित्थजम्बूफलसार भक्षितम् ।
उमासुतं शोकविनाशकारणं नमामि विघ्नेश्वर पादपङ्कजम् ॥



gajānanam bhūta-gaṇādi-sevitam kapittha-jambū-phala-sāra bhakṣitam ।
umā-sutam śoka-vināśa-kāraṇam namāmi vighneśvara pāda-paṅkajam ॥

Preface

दिशन्तु शं मे गुरुपादपांसवः

diśantu śaṁ me guru-pāda-pāṁsavah

May auspiciousness flow from the sacred dust of Guru's feet

Srimad Bhagavad Gita is a unique and unparalleled jewel among all scriptures. It serves as a guiding light not only for renunciant but also for those laden with worldly responsibilities, attempting to balance the material with the spiritual. It advocates them to be impartial in the dealings of their body and mind, which, out of ignorance, they get identified with. It is a wrong notion that, in order to accomplish one's duties in life, a sense of attachment is necessary. Lord Krishna, the greatest *samsari* (an active worldly being) of all, is a perfect unattached *asamsari* (a transcendental being). He demonstrates through his actions and words, how to function in this tangible, material world while remaining grounded in the sublime bliss.

To attain this state, one needs proper guidance from capable teachers who show the path that initially appears to be conflicting and full of challenges. As pointed out by the deep insight of the author of this master guide book in verses 52-53 of Ch 2: "The purpose of the teacher and scriptures is to shake us out of delusion. Confusions and challenges are a part of spiritual journey as we let go of our worldly thinking patterns and seek refuge in the higher reality. As we thus progress, we begin to gain clarity on the path."

This book leads the readers, through the author's revolutionary contemplations, from body to mind and from mind to consciousness, penetrating the layers of one's existence. The introspective questions under the title *Mananam* in each section give no respite to those who are engaged in self appeasement and self-deceit (*atma pravanchana*) and challenges them towards a honest self-assessment. On the other hand, the words under Inspiration serves as an inexhaustible source of positivity making the arduous and confusing spiritual path relatively easier.

This handbook gives ample material for aspirants to find solution to the various issues of life, not outwardly but within oneself. The content of this book shows the profound understanding of the author on the human psychology — progressing first to a positive mental state and then beyond it, to the innermost eternal Self. As the readers of this book embark on this journey, they are certain to surpass the domain of human mind and arrive at the *ādhiṣṭhāna caitanyam* (ultimate substratum of sentiency), by the grace of the singer of this celestial song, *Bhagavad Gita*.

May the selfless effort of Swami Nirgunanda Giriji in penning his thoughts for the benefit of the seekers be blessed by the Eternal Teacher, Lord Shri Krishna.

मङ्गलम् सर्वम्
maṅgalam sarvam

Swami Swananda Tirtha

Acharya, Shree Kailash Ashram,
Rishikesh - Himalayas

Introduction

Life presents each of us with unique challenges and trials. On the battlefield of Kurukshetra, when Arjuna faced one of the greatest moral and existential crises, Lord Krishna imparted to his anguished disciple the sacred teaching of discovering the spiritual within the mundane — delivered in ways both succinct and practical. These sublime teachings, the very essence of the Upanishads, were passed down to us by Sage Vyasa in the form of the *Srimad Bhagavad Gita*, the Divine Song.

Your circumstances may differ from those of Arjuna; your challenges may be varied, and your path may be uncertain. Yet the universal teachings of the Gita offer every seeker of truth a model for self-improvement and spiritual growth. The *Srimad Bhagavad Gita* is not meant solely for dedicated spiritual aspirants — it also serves as a practical handbook for everyday life. Anyone seeking to balance work and family responsibilities, maintain mental peace, and attain freedom from stress will find its teachings invaluable.

This workbook-style journal is not intended to impart the teachings of the Gita or to offer commentary — many revered Gurus and scholars have already done so with great depth. Instead, *Gita Mananam* is designed to help you contemplate the Gita's teachings and integrate them into your daily life.

Rooted in the Upanishadic spirit of the Gita, the journal honours the traditional practice of *Mananam*—the reflective assimilation of what has already been heard (*shravanam*) or studied (*adhyayanam*).

This journal invites you to explore the wisdom of the Gita, deepen your understanding, and apply its timeless insights to your personal and spiritual journey. The reflective questions accompanying selected shlokas are crafted to help you uncover personal meaning within the teachings, fostering greater clarity amid life's circumstances.

Just as Lord Krishna inspired Arjuna to engage in his righteous battle, may the Lord inspire you through this work to navigate your own daily duties with courage and discernment. The eternal purpose of the *Srimad Bhagavad Gita*, the celestial song, is to help you find inner peace and personal growth while remaining anchored in the Divine—even as you fulfil your worldly responsibilities.

I am grateful to Raghupathi Sringeri and Sheshagiri K M for the artworks used in this book. Several students from my Gita class dedicated themselves to proofreading, editing, translating, designing, and overseeing the printing process. I invoke the Lord's blessings for their selfless service, offered for the benefit of all readers.

Swami Nirgunananda Giri

Rishikesh, Bharata

How to use the Book

Since this is not a typical Gita study book, the following approach will help maximise its benefits.

Sequential Reading of Shlokas — This book provides all the Gita *shlokas* (verses) along with their meanings. Read through the verses in the given order before engaging with the *Mananam* (Contemplation) and *inspiration* sections.

Contextual Understanding — While the *Mananam* questions focus on specific *shlokas*, it is beneficial to read the preceding verses to grasp the broader context.

Background in Gita Shravanam — Ideally, one should have studied the Gita through structured exposition by a traditional Vedanta teacher (*shravanam*). However, such *shravanam* and prior formal study is not mandatory for using this book.

Deep Reflection on Mananam Questions — After reading the *shlokas*, engage with the *Mananam* questions thoughtfully. Read them multiple times, contemplating how they apply to your life and how their wisdom can be practiced or implemented.

Writing and Revisiting — Ponder upon the questions, and if necessary, revisit the *shlokas*. Make notes in the space provided in the book or in a separate notebook, recording insights and reflections.

Cultivating Jignāsu — If additional questions arise during contemplation, write them down as well. This enquiry (*jignāsu*) will naturally fuel the quest for deeper understanding.

Gaining Perspective — Conclude by reading the *inspiration* notes. Compare them with your interpretations—do they align with your insights or offer new perspectives?

Informal Contemplation — Beyond structured study, integrate contemplation into daily life. Select *Mananam* questions that resonate with you, and reflect on them during free moments throughout the day.

Prioritising Depth Over Quantity — The impact of this book lies not in how much is read, but in the quality and depth of contemplation. If you read for five minutes, dedicate at least 10–15 minutes to formal contemplation, allowing the teachings to permeate your thoughts informally throughout the day.

Living the Teachings — Let the fragrance of the Gita infuse every aspect of your life, enriching your interactions and radiating wisdom to those around you.

Chapter 7

Jñāna Vijnāna Yoga

(Yoga of Wisdom and Practice)



श्रीभगवानुवाच —

मय्यासक्तमनाः पार्थ योगं युञ्जन्मदाश्रयः ।

असंशयं समग्रं मां यथा ज्ञास्यसि तच्छृणु ॥ ७.१ ॥

śrībhagavān uvāca —

mayaśaktamanāḥ pārtha yōgaṁ yuñjanmadāśrayaḥ ।

asaṁśayaṁ samagraṁ mām yathā jñāsyasi tacchṛṇu ॥ 7.1 ॥

Sri Bhagavan said: O Arjuna, centre your mind upon Me, seek refuge in Me, and engage in the discipline of yoga. In this way, you shall come to know Me completely, without any doubt. Now, hear how this knowledge unfolds.

ज्ञानं तेऽहं सविज्ञानमिदं वक्ष्याम्यशेषतः ।

यज्ज्ञात्वा नेह भूयोऽन्यज्ज्ञातव्यमवशिष्यते ॥ ७.२ ॥

jñānaṁ tē:'haṁ savijñānamidaṁ vakṣyāmyaśēṣataḥ ।

yajjñātvā nēha bhūyō:'nyajjñātavyamavaśiṣyatē ॥ 7.2 ॥

I shall now impart to you complete knowledge together with practical wisdom (realisation). When you grasp this fully, nothing else in this world will remain for you to know.

Mananam Sloka - 2

Am I inclined to seek spiritual knowledge without applying it in practice? As in other areas of life, what distinguishes theoretical knowledge from practical understanding in spiritual life? How can my spiritual insights translate into wisdom and personal realisation, making them applicable in everyday life?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

In every aspect of life, there is a distinction between theoretical and practical knowledge. While spiritual knowledge can have general applications, the way each individual applies it in his or her own life will vary. However, there is a key difference in spiritual knowledge: unlike other fields where the accumulation of knowledge is limitless, spiritual knowledge has an endpoint. Brahma Vidya is described as that knowledge by which all other knowledge becomes known—knowing One leads to knowing all!

मनुष्याणां सहस्रेषु कश्चिद्यतति सिद्धये ।

यततामपि सिद्धानां कश्चिन्मां वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ॥ ७.३ ॥

manuṣyāṇāṁ sahasrēṣu kaścidyatati siddhayē ।
yatatāmapī siddhānāṁ kaścīnmāṁ vētti tattvataḥ ॥ 7.3 ॥

Among thousands of people, only a few strive for perfection. And even among those rare ones who reach perfection, only one in thousands truly perceives My essence.

भूमिरापोऽनलो वायुः खं मनो बुद्धिरेव च ।

अहङ्कार इतीयं मे भिन्ना प्रकृतिरष्टधा ॥ ७.४ ॥

bhūmirāpō:'nalō vāyuḥ khaṁ manō buddhirēva ca ।
ahaṅkāra itīyaṁ mē bhinnā prakṛtirasṭadhā ॥ 7.4 ॥

Earth, water, fire, air, space, mind, intellect, and ego—these eight constitute My separated material energies.

अपरेयमितस्त्वन्यां प्रकृतिं विद्धि मे पराम् ।

जीवभूतां महाबाहो ययेदं धार्यते जगत् ॥ ७.५ ॥

aparēyamitastvanyāṁ prakṛtiṁ viddhi mē parām ।
jīvabhūtāṁ mahābāhō yayēdaṁ dhāryatē jagat ॥ 7.5 ॥

O mighty-armed Arjuna, beyond this lower Prakriti, know that there exists a higher Prakriti of Mine. It is the source of all living beings, and through it the entire universe is upheld.

एतद्योनीनि भूतानि सर्वाणीत्युपधारय ।

अहं कृत्स्नस्य जगतः प्रभवः प्रलयस्तथा ॥ ७.६ ॥

ētadyōnīni bhūtāni sarvāṇītyupadhāraya ।
ahaṁ kṛtsnasya jagataḥ prabhavaḥ pralayastathā ॥ 7.6 ॥

Know that all beings arise from these two prakritis' wombs. I am the origin of the entire universe, and I am also its dissolution.

Mananam Sloka - 3

Can I observe in my own society and surroundings that many people are focused on pursuing material goals? Can I see that others are primarily engaged in achieving personal success in their respective fields? Why is it that so few pursue genuine self-development and spiritual growth? Even among those who seek to discover their true Self or connect with the Divine, why do so few manage to persevere to the end? In my own life, what are the obstacles preventing me from choosing the higher path to lasting happiness?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

One of the Upanishads teaches that all human beings have a choice in their life's path. Some choose the path that pleases the senses and feeds the ego—this is the path of preyas. Others commit to the path of the higher good, which leads to ultimate happiness—this is the path of shreyas. Although many people are aware of these paths, very few choose to walk the latter. And even among those who do, only a few persist. This is where the guidance of the Scriptures, Gurus, and the support of the right companions become essential for a seeker (sadhaka). They are your most loyal cheerleaders!

Mananam Sloka - 4, 5

What are the various forces in nature that we experience? From a scientific perspective, we categorise them as matter, energy, and even mind. Are these forces in nature independent, or are they interdependent? Could there be another force distinct from these, yet sustaining them both? Can I directly observe the workings of these different forces in nature without relying on concepts from science or religion?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

The Gita is pointing to us that Para and Apra Prakriti are the two forces at work in nature. While the functions of mind and matter are evident to all, the role of Consciousness, which supports and holds all matter together, remains a profound mystery that humans are meant to unravel. As long as we are content with a life identified with matter, or at most, with the mind, our true identity will remain hidden from us. A jignasu is someone who sincerely desires to know this deeper reality, while a mumukshu is one who is determined to pursue it at any cost.

मत्तः परतरं नान्यत्किञ्चिदस्ति धनञ्जय ।

मयि सर्वमिदं प्रोतं सूत्रे मणिगणा इव ॥ ७.७ ॥

mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyatkiñcidasti dhanañjaya ।
mayi sarvamidaṁ prōtaṁ sūtrē maṇigaṇā iva ॥ 7.7 ॥

O Dhananjaya, there is nothing higher than Me. All that exists in the universe is woven into Me, as pearls are strung upon a thread.

रसोऽहमप्सु कौन्तेय प्रभास्मि शशिसूर्ययोः ।

प्रणवः सर्ववेदेषु शब्दः खे पौरुषं नृषु ॥ ७.८ ॥

rasō:'hamapsu kauntēya prabhāsmi śaśisūryayōḥ ।
praṇavaḥ sarvavēdēṣu śabdaḥ khē pauṛuṣaṁ nṛṣu ॥ 7.8 ॥

O Kaunteya, I am the very essence of water, the radiance of the sun and the moon, the sacred syllable Om in all the Vedas, the sound that pervades space, and the essential strength found in human beings.

पुण्यो गन्धः पृथिव्यां च तेजश्चास्मि विभावसौ ।

जीवनं सर्वभूतेषु तपश्चास्मि तपस्विषु ॥ ७.९ ॥

puṇyō gandhaḥ pṛthivyāṁ ca tējaścāsmi vibhāvasau ।
jīvanaṁ sarvabhūteṣu tapaścāsmi tapasviṣu ॥ 7.9 ॥

I am the pure fragrance of the earth, the brilliance within fire, the life force that dwells in all beings, and the austerity of those who practise penance.

बीजं मां सर्वभूतानां विद्धि पार्थ सनातनम् ।

बुद्धिर्बुद्धिमतामस्मि तेजस्तेजस्विनामहम् ॥ ७.१० ॥

bījaṁ māṁ sarvabhūtānāṁ viddhi pārtha sanātanam ।
buddhirbuddhimatāmasmi tējastējasvināmaham ॥ 7.10 ॥

O Partha, know that I am the eternal seed of all beings. I am the wisdom that shines in the wise, and the radiance that illumines the radiant.

Mananam Sloka - 7

What do I understand to be the supreme force that governs all other forces of nature? How do I conceive of this essential energy that sustains everything, serving as the foundation of all creation? What insights do the Scriptures provide about this? Where and how can I see, know, or comprehend it? How can I perceive the workings of this central force within my own body and mind? Which spiritual practices might help me directly experience it?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

A necklace of pearls is held together by a thread, yet our attention is drawn to the beads, not the thread itself. Similarly, the Lord is the unseen force, the source of all other forces at work in the universe. For the spiritually aware, this Divine Energy is the essence of everything, though unseen—just as gravity is constantly at work, yet never directly perceived.

Mananam Sloka - 10

What is it within the tiny seed that allows it to grow into a giant tree? What gives the brain its ability to generate thought and expression? What illuminates the sunlight and the light of the stars? What infuses beauty into some of the most magnificent wonders of nature? Have I lost the curiosity and wonder of a child? Is there value in looking at nature with awe? Could such admiration lead me to discover the One Divine hiding behind it all?

** Self Reflection****Inspiration**

The beauty and complexity of creation cannot be a mere accident. The force that holds the planets and stars in place, that governs our digestion and respiration, must be the most noble presence in all of existence. If this presence were to demand payment for its services, we might be enslaved for eternity. Yet, the Lord serves us without expecting anything in return. Can we not at least express our gratitude for such unconditional love?

बलं बलवतां चाहं कामरागविवर्जितम् ।

धर्माविरुद्धो भूतेषु कामोऽस्मि भरतर्षभ ॥ ७.११ ॥

balam balavatām cāhaṁ kāmarāgavivarjitam ।

dharmāviruddhō bhūteṣu kāmō:'smi bharatarṣabha ॥ 7.11 ॥

I am the strength of the strong, free from desire and attachment.
And I am the desire that dwells in all beings, when it is in harmony
with dharma, O Bharatarṣabha (the best of the Bharata family).

ये चैव सात्त्विका भावा राजसास्तमसाश्च ये ।

मत्त एवेति तान्विद्धि न त्वहं तेषु ते मयि ॥ ७.१२ ॥

yē caiva sātṭvikā bhāvā rājasāstamasāśca yē ।

matta ēvēti tānviddhi na tvahaṁ teṣu tē mayi ॥ 7.12 ॥

All beings and objects that embody the qualities of sattva
(goodness), rajas (passion), and tamas (ignorance)—know that
these arise from Me. Yet I am not contained within them; rather,
they abide in Me.

त्रिभिर्गुणमयैर्भावैरेभिः सर्वमिदं जगत् ।

मोहितं नाभिजानाति मामेभ्यः परमव्ययम् ॥ ७.१३ ॥

tribhirguṇamayairbhāvairēbhiḥ sarvamidam jagat ।

mōhitam nābhijānāti māmēbhyaḥ paramavyayam ॥ 7.13 ॥

The entire world is deluded by the states of three guṇas—sattva,
rajas, and tamas, and thereby do not realise Me, the
imperishable reality, who stands beyond these qualities.

दैवी ह्येषा गुणमयी मम माया दुरत्यया ।

मामेव ये प्रपद्यन्ते मायामेतां तरन्ति ते ॥ ७.१४ ॥

daivī hyēṣā guṇamayī mama māyā duratyayā ।

māmēva yē prapadyantē māyāmētāṁ taranti tē ॥ 7.14 ॥

Truly, this divine māyā of Mine, woven from the three guṇas, is
exceedingly difficult to overcome. Yet those who surrender unto
Me cross beyond this māyā.

Mananam Slokas - 14

What is the nature of delusion? Could it be that we are all caught in a mass illusion, as the Hindu scriptures suggest? What are some of the actions that I have done in my life while in a deluded state of mind, only to regret later? What helps me return to a state of awareness? What habits do I still indulge in that may stem from a deluded mind? How can I avoid falling into such traps again? Is there any external guidance or support that can help me break free from these states?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration:**

The concept of Maya is one of the most profound explanations across world philosophies, describing the force that disconnects us from our true nature and the Divine. Modern examples like movies and virtual reality provide a tangible way to grasp the idea of Maya. Just as a magician manipulates and controls a magic show, there is a divine magician who governs the illusive power of Maya. The purpose of the magician is not based on some cruel or manipulative intent. Those who seek refuge in Him are lifted into reality, where the illusions and nightmares end forever.

न मां दुष्कृतिनो मूढाः प्रपद्यन्ते नराधमाः ।

माययापहतज्ञाना आसुरं भावमाश्रिताः ॥ ७.१५ ॥

na mām duṣkṛtinō mūḍhāḥ prapadyantē narādhmāḥ ।
māyayāpahatjñānā āsuram bhāvamāśritāḥ ॥ 7.15 ॥

The wicked, the deluded, and the lowest among men do not turn to Me. Those whose understanding is clouded by illusion (māyā), and who embrace demonic ways, likewise do not surrender to Me.

चतुर्विधा भजन्ते मां जनाः सुकृतिनोऽर्जुन ।

आर्तो जिज्ञासुरर्थार्थी ज्ञानी च भरतर्षभ ॥ ७.१६ ॥

caturvidhā bhajantē mām janāḥ sukr̥tinō'rjuna ।
ārtō jijñāsurarthaṥrthī jñānī ca bharatarṣabha ॥ 7.16 ॥

O Bharatarṣabha (Arjuna), four kinds of virtuous ones worship Me: those who are distressed, those seeking knowledge, those desiring worldly gains, and those endowed with wisdom.

तेषां ज्ञानी नित्ययुक्त एकभक्तिर्विशिष्यते ।

प्रियो हि ज्ञानिनोऽत्यर्थमहं स च मम प्रियः ॥ ७.१७ ॥

tēṣām jñānī nityayukta ēkabhaktirviśiṣyatē ।
priyō hi jñāninō'tyarthamaham sa ca mama priyaḥ ॥ 7.17 ॥

Among them, the wise devotee—ever steadfast and single-minded in devotion to Me—is the most distinguished. To them I am most beloved, and they are most beloved to Me.

उदाराः सर्व एवैते ज्ञानी त्वात्मैव मे मतम् ।

आस्थितः स हि युक्तात्मा मामेवानुत्तमां गतिम् ॥ ७.१८ ॥

udārāḥ sarva ēvaitē jñānī tvātmaiva mē matam । āsthitaḥ sa hi
yuktātmā māmēvānuttamām gatim ॥ 7.18 ॥

Indeed, all these seekers are noble. Yet the wise are regarded as My very Self. Such a person, steadfast in mind, is devoted solely to the supreme goal that is in Me.

Mananam Sloka - 15

What has inspired me to pursue the higher truth? What life experiences have guided me towards seeking God? Can I find gratitude in my past suffering or loss, or in moments of grace or guidance from revered ones, for leading me to the spiritual path? How can I maintain the wisdom to avoid falling back into a state of delusion where I neglect seeking the truth or honouring the Divine?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

Many people in this world are content without ever seeking spiritual practices or the truth of a higher being. These individuals, known as 'pamara,' are driven solely by sensual desires. They lack insight into higher realities and have no inclination to seek them. Their focus is entirely on finding happiness in the material world. However, deep within their hearts, there resides an unconscious fear of death and the afterlife, which continually nags at them.

Mananam Slokas - 16

Where am I in my journey towards God or Truth? What is my main motivation? Do I only pray to a higher power when I am in distress or need? Do I seek blessings from the great ones for worldly success and protection? Do I have a strong desire to know the Divine or the utmost essence of my own Being? Do I feel reverence or devotion towards those who impart higher wisdom? How can I purify my devotion to God and deepen my understanding of the ultimate Truth?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

Even among those who seek God, motivations can differ greatly. Initially, many seekers are driven by the desire to alleviate some form of suffering and attain worldly happiness. Some undertake spiritual practices to gain a competitive edge over others. Eventually, a genuine interest in understanding oneself and the greater force that sustains all creation may develop. With proper guidance, such seekers acquire the right wisdom, which further refines their motivation on the spiritual path. Our goals and desires in life are all based on our level of understanding.

बहूनां जन्मनामन्ते ज्ञानवान्मां प्रपद्यते ।

वासुदेवः सर्वमिति स महात्मा सुदुर्लभः ॥ ७.१९ ॥

bahūnām janmanāmantē jñānavānmām prapadyatē |
vāsudēvaḥ sarvamiti sa mahātmā sudurlabhāḥ || 7.19 ||

After many births, the wise one takes refuge in Me. Realising that Vāsudeva is all, such a great soul is exceedingly rare.

कामैस्तैस्तैर्हृतज्ञानाः प्रपद्यन्तेऽन्यदेवताः ।

तं तं नियममास्थाय प्रकृत्या नियताः स्वया ॥ ७.२० ॥

kāmaistaistairhṛtajñānāḥ prapadyantē:'nyadēvatāḥ |
taṁ taṁ niyamamāsthāya prakṛtyā niyatāḥ svayā || 7.20 ||

Driven by one or other desires, people turn to various deities. They follow one or the other practices, as dictated by their tendencies.

यो यो यां यां तनुं भक्तः श्रद्धयार्चितुमिच्छति ।

तस्य तस्याचलां श्रद्धां तामेव विदधाम्यहम् ॥ ७.२१ ॥

yō yō yām yām tanuṁ bhaktaḥ śraddhayārcitumicchati |
tasya tasyācalāṁ śraddhām tāmēva vidadhāmyaham || 7.21 ||

Whatever form of deity a devotee seeks to worship with faith, I make that faith steady and unwavering in them.

स तया श्रद्धया युक्तस्तस्या राधनमीहते ।

लभते च ततः कामान्मयैव विहितान्हि तान् ॥ ७.२२ ॥

sa tayā śraddhayā yuktastasyā rāadhanamīhatē |
labhatē ca tataḥ kāmānmayaiva vihitānhi tān || 7.22 ||

Endowed with that faith, the devotee seeks the deity of their choice. From that deity they obtain their desired objects, though it is I alone who grant them those fruits.

Mananam Sloka 18, 19

How can I enhance my wisdom and gain realisation on the spiritual path? Why is it important to maintain balance between devotion and concentration while also advancing in knowledge? What makes the path of knowledge (Jnana Yoga) unique? Why does the Lord extol those on this path to be the dearest and closest to Divine? What is the vision and outlook of a spiritually wise person toward which I can aspire?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

The pinnacle of wisdom is realising oneness with the Divine and perceiving that Divinity in everything. Only then can all seeking come to an end. All other forms of worldly wisdom and the forces that sustain it will still uphold a dualistic vision. Where there is duality, the suffering of samsara will persist. Such wisdom is attained only when one refuses to compromise with lesser truths and their rewards.

21 Mananam:

Mananam Sloka - 21

What is the nature of my faith? Is it merely a feeling, a sense of loyalty, or blind faith? How did I decide to follow this path? Have I reflected deeply enough on it? Do I observe any progress or positive changes in me and in my daily life? Does my intellectual understanding align with my intuitive sense? Does this path offer a vision of the supreme truth and the means to attain it? Or, does it require me to become one-sided and look down on other paths and means?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

As one's understanding deepens, so do one's aspirations, both in worldly and spiritual life. With deep commitment to any path, our faith intensifies. Consequently, there are various 'darsanas' (views or philosophies) even among those who follow the same scriptures, each claiming to hold the ultimate truth. This verse cautions us against placing our faith in the wrong people and means without proper study and discernment. While being faithful to one's path is commendable, it is problematic if the path is dogmatic and dismissive of others. In such cases, we must reconsider our approach.

अन्तवत्तु फलं तेषां तद्भवत्यल्पमेधसाम् ।

देवान्देवयजो यान्ति मद्भक्ता यान्ति मामपि ॥ ७.२३ ॥

antavattu phalaṁ tēṣāṁ tadbhavatyalpamēdhasām ।

dēvāndēvayajō yānti madbhaktā yānti māmapi ॥ 7.23 ॥

But the results gained by such people of limited understanding is fleeting. Those who worship other deities go to those deities. Yet those who worship Me come (directly) to Me alone.

अव्यक्तं व्यक्तिमापन्नं मन्यन्ते मामबुद्धयः ।

परं भावमजानन्तो ममाव्ययमनुत्तमम् ॥ ७.२४ ॥

avyaktaṁ vyaktimāpannaṁ manyantē māmabuddhayaḥ । paraṁ
bhāvamajānantō mamāvyayamanuttamam ॥ 7.24 ॥

Those without wisdom think of Me, the unmanifest, as having assumed manifestation. They do not know My supreme, imperishable, and unsurpassed nature.

नाहं प्रकाशः सर्वस्य योगमायासमावृतः ।

मूढोऽयं नाभिजानाति लोको मामजमव्ययम् ॥ ७.२५ ॥

nāhaṁ prakāśaḥ sarvasya yōgamāyāsamāvṛtaḥ ।

mūḍhō:'yaṁ nābhijānāti lōkō māmajamavyayam ॥ 7.25 ॥

I am not manifest to all, being veiled by My divine illusive power (yoga-māyā). This deluded world does not know Me, the unborn and imperishable.

वेदाहं समतीतानि वर्तमानानि चार्जुन ।

भविष्याणि च भूतानि मां तु वेद न कश्चन ॥ ७.२६ ॥

vēdāhaṁ samatītāni vartamānāni cārjuna ।

bhaviṣyāṇi ca bhūtāni mām tu vēda na kaścana ॥ 7.26 ॥

O Arjuna, I know all beings—past, present, and future. Yet none truly knows Me (in My entirety).

Mananam Sloka - 23

Which forms of gods or deities do I worship or pray to? What outcomes or rewards do I seek from these practices? Are the promised results of my practices finite and time-bound? Is my devotion directed towards lesser gods or the Supreme? Do I have a sufficient understanding of the Supreme Being, the Self, and the ultimate Truth?

** Self Reflection****Inspiration**

Regardless of the nature of our practices, we should aspire to realize the Supreme Being, which is the ultimate reality of our own existence. All other forms of worship and practices will only provide short-term rewards. True wisdom, acquired through a lineage of gurus and the Scriptures, ensures that we remain on the right path and that our efforts will not be diverted from the supreme goal of life.

इच्छाद्वेषसमुत्थेन द्वन्द्वमोहेन भारत ।

सर्वभूतानि संमोहं सर्गे यान्ति परन्तप ॥ ७.२७ ॥

icchādvēṣasamutthēna dvandvamōhēna bhārata ।
sarvabhūtāni saṁmōhaṁ sargē yānti parantapa ॥ 7.27 ॥

O Bhārata, O Parantapa (Arjuna), all beings are deluded at birth
by the dualities of desire and aversion, arising from delusion.

येषां त्वन्तगतं पापं जनानां पुण्यकर्मणाम् ।

ते द्वन्द्वमोहनिर्मुक्ता भजन्ते मां दृढव्रताः ॥ ७.२८ ॥

yēṣāṁ tvantagataṁ pāpaṁ janānāṁ puṇyakarmaṇām ।
tē dvandvamōhanirmuktā bhajantē mām dṛḍhavrataḥ ॥ 7.28 ॥

Freed from sin, purified by righteous action, and freed from
the delusion of dualities, such steadfast ones worship Me with
steadfast vows.

जरामरणमोक्षाय मामाश्रित्य यतन्ति ये ।

ते ब्रह्म तद्विदुः कृत्स्नमध्यात्मं कर्म चाखिलम् ॥ ७.२९ ॥

jarāmaraṇamōkṣāya māmāśritya yatanti yē ।
tē brahma tadviduḥ kṛtsnamadhyātmaṁ karma cākḥilam ॥ 7.29 ॥

Those who strive for liberation from old age and death, taking
refuge in Me, they know Brahman, the Self, and all action in its
entirety.

साधिभूताधिदैवं मां साधियज्ञं च ये विदुः ।

प्रयाणकालेऽपि च मां ते विदुर्युक्तचेतसः ॥ ७.३० ॥

sādhibhūtādhidaivaṁ mām sādhiyajñaṁ ca yē viduḥ ।
prayāṇakālē'pi ca mām tē viduryuktacētasah ॥ 7.30 ॥

Those who know Me along with the knowledge of the material
elements (adhibhūta), the divine beings (adhidaiva), and
sacrifice (adhiyajña)—such steadfast ones know Me even at the
time of death.

Mananam Sloka - 29

Who and what are my sources of support in the world? In which areas can I rely on my family, friends, and others for support? In which areas might I not be able to rely on them? Under what conditions are worldly sources of refuge inadequate or limited? What concept can I envision for a refuge that transcends these limitations? How can such an infinite being be the ultimate assurance, enhancing my sense of self?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

In many aspects of material life, we can rely on support from people, society, and the government. However, when facing the inevitability of old age and death, our highest refuge is God alone. Regardless of how much we rationalise, the mind needs something to hold onto. For a practitioner, the form of God or a felt presence of the Divine provides that support. For one who is stabilised in wisdom, the realisation of the Self and its unbroken connection with the Infinite serves as that anchor.

ॐ तत्सदिति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीतासूपनिषत्सु ब्रह्मविद्यायां योगशास्त्रे
श्रीकृष्णार्जुनसंवादे ज्ञानविज्ञानयोगो नाम सप्तमोऽध्यायः ॥

ōṃ tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītās ūpaniṣatsu
brahmavidyāyāṃ yōgaśāstrē
śrīkṛṣṇārjunasaṃvādē jñānavijñānayōgō
nāma prathamodhyāyaḥ ॥



IAST Sanskrit

Vowels	
Devanagari	IAST
अ	a
आ	ā
इ	i
ई	ī
उ	u
ऊ	ū
ऋ	r̥
ॠ	r̄
ऌ	l̥
ॡ	l̄
ए	e
ऐ	ai
ओ	o
औ	au

Special Characters	
Devanagari	IAST
ँ	ṁ
ः	ḥ
ँ	ṁ
ॐ	oṃ
ऽ	'

Devanagari	IAST
क	ka
ख	kha
ग	ga
घ	gha
ङ	ṅa
च	ca
छ	cha
ज	ja
झ	jha
ञ	ña
ट	ṭa
ठ	ṭha
ड	ḍa
ढ	ḍha
ण	ṇa

Devanagari	IAST
त	ta
थ	tha
द	da
ध	dha
न	na
प	pa
फ	pha
ब	ba
भ	bha
म	ma
य	ya
र	ra
ल	la
व	va
श	śa
ष	ṣa
स	sa
ह	ha



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